

FAQs for Parish Book Fair Coordinators

Quick answers to the most frequently asked questions that come up after your fair has been scheduled.

● PLANNING & PREPARATION

Q How will I know what to do, what to expect, and how to plan for my fair?

We will guide you every step of the way. Our Guide to a Successful Ignatius Book Fair covers every step you need to run a great fair. If you like to have a one-stop shop, this guide will be a wonderful resource. Our emails will break it down into bite-sized nuggets every ten days or so leading up to your fair, giving you an opportunity to take small action steps toward executing a successful fair. Our three-part workshop series will feature live, interactive help with our book fair managers, taking the guide and breaking it down into three key areas. You will have a chance to ask questions during these workshops, you'll know you're on schedule, and you'll get to see real-life examples of a fair coming together from start to finish. Lastly, our book fair managers and customer support team are here to help.

● MATERIALS & SHIPPING

Q When will my books and materials arrive?

Your books and other materials will arrive one week before your fair, if not earlier. They will arrive via UPS and in most cases, we will send you a tracking number once the materials have left our warehouse. This will give you time to plan for having staff on hand to accept the shipment and store it until you are ready to set up.

Q What arrives with my shipment?

Your shipment will include all books and other items available for sale, two point-of-sale payment devices, book fair flyers to send home before the fair, table category signs, book stands to help display titles, five decorative posters, tablecloths in our colors of mint green, yellow, and orange, and bookmarks.

Q What if something arrives damaged?

We apologize if anything arrives in less-than-ideal condition! If so, please take a picture and send it to your book fair manager right away. She will instruct you on what to do.

Q What other materials might I need for my fair that aren't included?

We don't send these items, but we recommend bags so customers can carry their purchases home, a cash box with change for those paying in cash, a notebook at your checkout station to record any events you need clarification on later, packing tape for repacking books once your fair concludes, a Sharpie marker, and any additional décor to make your fair come alive. For décor, we suggest balloons, twinkle lights, streamers, or a fun theme. Book fairs are wonderful events for children – and core, happy memories. Anything you can do to make the fair more memorable and fun is a bonus – appreciated by all.

● PAYMENTS & SALES

Q What payments can we accept? How is it recorded?

The payment devices can ring up transactions paid in cash, check, or credit card.

Q Who does the customer make out the check to?

All checks will be made out to your organization, deposited into your account, and held until you receive our invoice, which typically arrives 2–3 weeks after your fair ends.

Q If we are tax-exempt, why do customers have to pay sales tax?

If your organization is tax-exempt, it will not pay sales tax on books purchased by and for it. Your customers are still obligated to pay sales tax as determined by your local, state, and federal tax laws. The tax rate for your area will be automatically calculated by the handheld payment device where applicable. After the fair, when making purchases for your organization using your reward dollars, you will not be assessed tax if we have your tax-exempt certificate on file.

DURING THE FAIR

Q What happens if we run out of a title or item during the fair?

We have a system in place to make this a non-issue. Our Last Copy Procedure, coupled with our Ship to Organization Spreadsheet, are designed to maximize your fair's success — and we'll walk you through both in detail. Essentially, any item we currently sell can be requested at the checkout station, paid for at that time, and delivered to your organization approximately fourteen business days after your fair concludes.

AFTER THE FAIR

Q How long do I have to close out the fair once it has ended?

You will have three days to gather everything up, choose books to keep with your rewards dollars, pack up the rest, and schedule a pickup.

Q How do we send unsold items back?

Included in our closing instructions is a link for you to fill out. Once you finish packing everything up, let us know how many boxes you are returning, and we will email you return labels to tape to the boxes. You can also choose a pickup date 2–3 days later for UPS to collect your boxes.

Q When can we expect ordered items to arrive once the fair is over?

We are as excited as you are to get your orders out quickly. It typically takes about fourteen business days for our team to reconcile your order and ship it.

Q If a customer has ordered online, how are rewards calculated? Where is the order sent?

During your in-person fair, customers will also have an opportunity to shop online. All online orders will be held until your fair ends and shipped out quickly once it concludes. If the customer has chosen your organization as the delivery address, all orders will arrive in a box (or boxes), together, individually labeled for each customer. All online orders earn rewards equaling thirty percent of the item list price in Ave Dollars. You can use these Ave Dollars to purchase books for your organization. There is no cash-back option for online purchases. Additionally, online orders do not count towards your in-person fair total.

Q When will I receive an invoice?

Once your fair is over and your returns have been received, our accounting team will begin preparing your invoice. It will reflect the money your organization accepted via cash and check (credit card payments are automatically sent to us). It will also specify the check amount owed. This total will vary depending on whether you choose to receive your rewards in Ave Dollars or cash. You should expect to receive your invoice about three weeks after your fair ends.

Need help? We're here for you.

Call our customer support line before, during, or after your fair.
Available 7am Eastern – 9pm Pacific

888-771-2321

